Deutsche Bank
Research

Rating
Sell

North America
United States

Health Care
Medical Supplies & Devices

Company
Intuitive Surgical

Reuters	Bloomberg	Exchange	Ticker
ISRG.OQ	ISRG US	NMS	ISRG

Date
17 July 2026

Forecast Change

Price at 16 Jul 2026 (USD)	402.33
Price Target	324.00
52-week range	592.85 - 379.50

Choppy 2Q; maintain SELL and lower PT to $324

Valuation & Risks

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Key changes

TP	366.00 to 324.00	↓	-11.5%
EPS (USD)	10.43 to 10.88	↑	4.3%
Revenue (USDm)	11,552 to 11,747	↑	1.7%

Source: Deutsche Bank

Portfolio Manager Summary

While 2Q WW procedure growth of +15% came in more or less in line with consensus, US volume growth of +12% fell short of expectations even despite having been tempered post HCA's preannouncement earlier this week, which showed weak inpatient and outpatient surgery volumes. While HCA attributed this weakness mainly to ACA premium subsidy cuts, we subsequently got more reassuring results and commentary from both J&J and Abbott – with neither citing any meaningful hit to their procedure volume-sensitive businesses from these cuts (and UNH remarking this morning that utilization held fairly steady in 2Q) – precipitating a relief rally for medtech stocks.

However, this week's roller-coaster ride now promises to continue post-ISRG's results, with management positing that ACA subsidy cuts drove slower-than-expected US da Vinci volume growth based on an observed sequential deceleration across several major elective/deferrable robotic surgery categories including benign hysterectomy, cholecystectomy, and hernia repair. Given this dynamic, procedure guidance was maintained, with full-year WW volume growth trending toward the midpoint of the +13.5% to +15.5% range. This lack of procedure upside is notable and will likely disappoint investors, given the company's long and consistent history of beating and raising. We lower our full-year US and WW procedure growth forecasts to +12.1% (down 110bps) +14.9% (down 30bps), respectively.

On systems, gross placements comfortably bettered consensus (468 vs. 446), reflecting continued healthy US demand for dV5. However, net installed base growth has clearly slowed over the past few quarters, and we continue to model further deceleration going forward. Notably, installations within the ASC channel are gaining nice momentum, thanks to launch of XiR into this more cost-sensitive channel, which should help drive higher technology adoption for simpler cases that are increasingly being performed in this site of care.

International installations were in line, though continued weakness in China placements is highly noteworthy, given that this market had previously been a key driver of OUS systems and procedure growth. While the company had placed 55–60 units in China in each of the past few years, only two systems were installed in 2Q and just six YTD vs 29 in 1H25, as the da Vinci tender win rate continues to

decline amidst intensifying competition from domestically-made platforms. On the procedure side, while China technology adoption had been meaningfully accretive to consolidated volume growth, the dramatic slowdown in installed base expansion is now resulting in decelerating procedure growth as capacity utilization maxes out. In India, while 2Q volumes were notably strong, our recent checks with large Indian hospital systems point to continued installed base share gains by lower-cost systems made in India and China. We will be meeting with several Asian competitors next week at SRS to better understand the competitive landscape in these two key OUS robotic surgery markets. dV5 did receive Indian regulatory approval earlier this week, though we foresee fairly limited uptake of the premium-priced robot in this highly cost-sensitive market.

In the I&A segment, as noted in the May press release, the company expects to begin launching Extended Use round two in the first half of 2027, which will enable customers to perform more surgeries per instrument for a handful of high-volume devices. The company did not provide much additional detail on the call, such as the number of instruments impacted or additional number of uses per unit, making it impossible to quantify the financial impact on the all-important I&A revenue-per-procedure line in 2027 and beyond. But based on the first round of Extended Use in 2021, which negatively impacted revenue per procedure by ~7%, it is fair to assume that this round will likewise exert meaningful pressure on this key model input over the next couple of years. Management's strategic rationale here is that the lower price point will drive higher adoption of robotic surgery, with which we concur – though our strong suspicion is that this was also a defensive move to help mitigate the impact from lower-cost remanufactured instruments and as more surgical robots are commercially launched in the US over the next couple of years. Regardless, bottom line is that launch of Extended Use round two will exert a meaningful hit to top-line growth in 2027–28.

On remanufactured instruments, while management continues to downplay this risk factor to its crown-jewel I&A business, our checks continue to confirm significant interest and growing adoption by hospitals, given the sizable discount vs. de novo instruments. In speaking with several major robotics programs, including HCA, Intuitive's largest US customer, adoption of the remanufactured monopolar scissors, the largest I&A SKU at ~14% of segment sales, continues to increase – and which we estimate has now captured ~5%–7% share of this product category. As several additional remanufactured instruments receive FDA approval and launch in coming quarters, we believe this will increasingly start to weigh on Intuitive's top line, specifically I&A per procedure, in 2027 and especially 2028.

Hence, with the deep moat that has heretofore surrounded the I&A segment—and justified the massive valuation premium for ISRG shares—increasingly at risk, and now coupled with growing questions around weakening fundamentals, including slowing US procedure growth, intensifying competition in key OUS markets such as China, and hospital margin pressures that could lead to capex budget cuts, we remain Sell-rated on ISRG shares and lower our PT to $324 vs $366 previously based on our valuation framework that continues to assume a 75% PEG premium vs a peer group of high-quality large-cap medtech peers (SYK, EW, and MDLN).

Upside risks to our target valuation include commercial execution missteps by third-party remanufacturers, lower-than-expected adoption of remanufactured instruments, and meaningful fundamental upside to procedure growth and/or dV5 placements and net installed base growth.

Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

Disclosure checklist

Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Intuitive Surgical	ISRG.OQ	402.33 (USD) 16 Jul 2026	2, 14, 24

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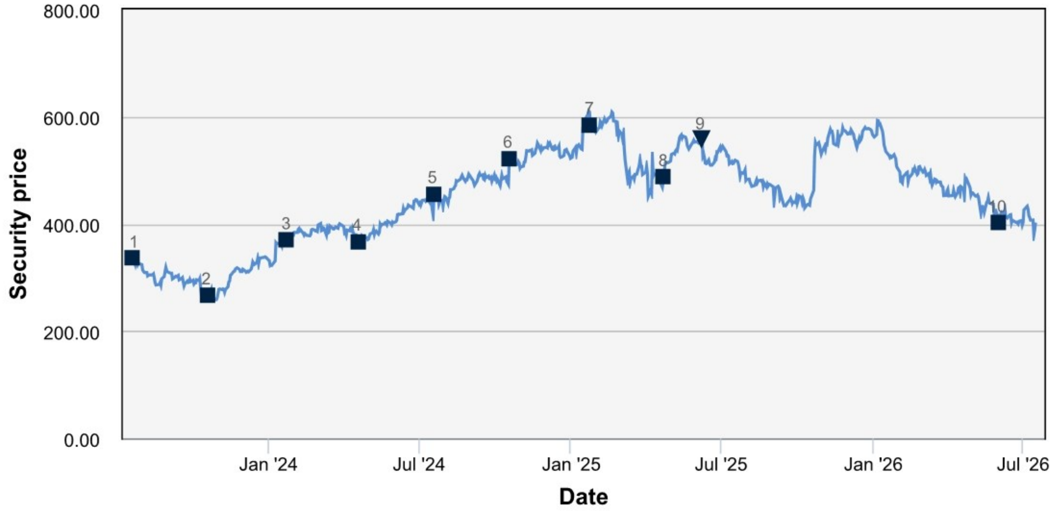
Historical recommendations and target price: Intuitive Surgical (ISRG.OQ)

(as of 07/16/2026)



Current Recommendations

Buy
Hold
Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

** Analyst is no longer at Deutsche Bank

1.	07/21/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 335.00, Current Price USD 336.66 Imron Zafar
2.	10/20/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 275.00, Current Price USD 266.91 Imron Zafar
3.	01/24/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 370.00, Current Price USD 370.07 Imron Zafar
4.	04/19/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 390.00, Current Price USD 366.34 Imron Zafar
5.	07/19/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 445.00, Current Price USD 455.01 Imron Zafar
6.	10/18/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 505.00, Current Price USD 521.15 Imron Zafar
7.	01/24/2025	Hold, Target Price Change USD 585.00, Current Price USD 584.05 Imron Zafar
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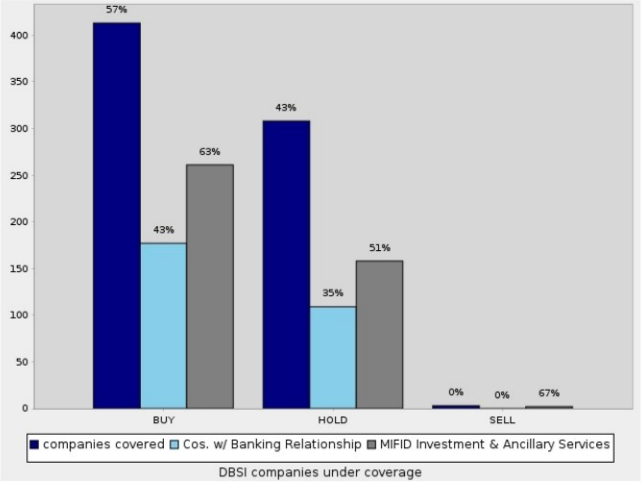
10.	06/02/2026	Sell, Target Price Change USD 366.00, Current Price USD 402.30 Imron Zafar

Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



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